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ANALYSIS REPORT · 28 OCTOBER 2026

The 50,000-baht solar scheme Who gains, who loses, and the options to know

Thailand's people-solar scheme commits about 50 billion baht of public money. It is a welcome step for clean energy, but its rules may concentrate the benefits in a few hands. This report summarises the official terms, the approved installer list, the loan conditions, and what installers and households are saying.

50,000 baht	140,000 baht	1 in 26	693	2.20 / ≈4 baht
subsidy per meter	reference price, 5 kW kit	households eligible	installers approved by PEA	sell-back / buy price per unit

Main message
Electricity demand is rising worldwide and in Thailand. Everyone should be able to produce power freely and fairly, and get a fair benefit from it.

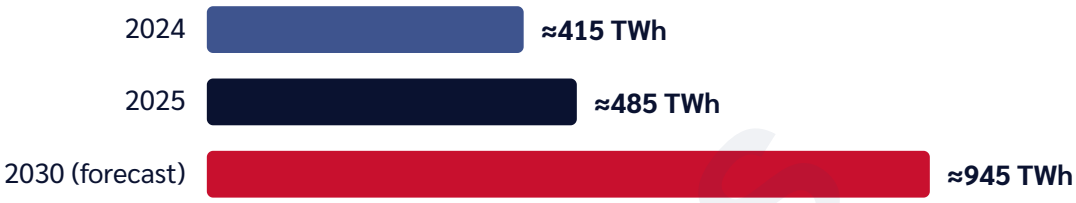
Key findings

1. **Small installers are squeezed**
   50,000–60,000 baht of security per job and 7-year obligations favour well-funded firms
2. **The rule-maker also competes**
   Two PEA subsidiaries are on the approved installer list
3. **Most recipients must borrow**
   About 90,000 baht over 7 years at 2.5% interest
4. **Places are limited**
   1 million homes out of about 26 million households
5. **Net metering risks being overshadowed**
   Though it needs no handout and reaches more people

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Introduction: why people must be part of solar power

The world needs much more electricity, driven by data centres and AI



Global data-centre electricity use (IEA) is set to roughly double within five years. AI chips use several times more power than ordinary servers.

26 projects
data centres approved by the BOI in 2025 (≈500 bn baht)

>1 trillion baht
new investment applications, Q1 2026

≈2.87 GW
planned power demand, mostly in the EEC

Why not generate from gas or coal?
Many big technology customers are RE100 members, which accept only renewable electricity such as solar and wind. Since 2024, most of it must come from plants built or repowered within the last 15 years. Thailand therefore needs a lot of new clean power.

Why people, not only big companies?
Support for people producing their own power has been limited. The 2019 people-solar scheme paid only 1.68 baht per unit with a quota of 100 MW a year (later raised to 2.20 baht), and the 200,000-baht tax deduction only began in late 2025.

Clean power should be clean at the source and in society
RE100 judges cleanliness at the source. Sustainability in the wider sense (the social side of ESG and a just transition) also asks who benefits. Letting households, local installers and small businesses produce power too makes clean energy fair for everyone.

Be honest and push forward together
The sharp rise in energy demand ahead, globally and nationally, asks everyone to be honest and to produce clean energy to their full potential. People must be able to take part freely and fairly, and get a fair benefit from the power they produce. Electricity is a public utility for our survival and sustainability, not purely for profit.

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RE100 and the social side: what the rules actually say

We checked the RE100 technical criteria (15 April 2025) and buyer frameworks: is community participation a requirement?

Question	What we found
What does RE100 require?	Renewable sources only, no coal co-firing, sustainability assurance for biomass and hydro. Since 2024, plants must be built or repowered within 15 years (up to 15% of use may be older).
What is exempt from the 15-year rule?	Self-generation, on-site or direct-line PPAs, and long-term project-specific contracts where the buyer is the original off-taker (PPAs, project-specific green tariffs).
Does RE100 require community benefit?	**No.** The criteria contain no rule on community participation, local ownership, benefit-sharing, human rights or land use (apart from biomass and hydro).
How does RE100 define "impact"?	Long-term contracts, project-specific contracts and recently built projects. Where barriers exist, buyers "should engage with suppliers and policymakers".

Where the social expectation comes from

1. **Buyers themselves**
   A 2023 Bain, TNC and CEBI study found more than half of US energy buyers already weigh "3C" attributes (Climate, Conservation, Communities), and over 60% expect them to become standard within five years.

2. **Buyer coalitions**
   The Clean Energy Buyers Institute's "Beyond the Megawatt" initiative published Principles of Purpose-Driven Energy Procurement covering resilience, sustainability and social factors.

3. **Reporting and finance rules**
   EU sustainability reporting (ESRS S3, Affected Communities) and IFC Performance Standards require companies and lenders to assess and engage affected communities.

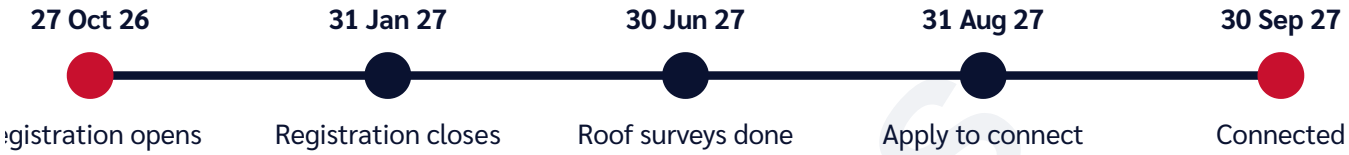
What this means for Thailand

Community participation is not an RE100 rule today, but it is a growing expectation of the companies that RE100 serves. New, project-specific household and community solar fits RE100's own definition of impact. Thailand opened direct PPAs to all industries in August 2026; small and community producers should be able to sell into them too. Community opposition is also now a leading cause of project delays in Europe (TNC).

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Scheme overview

The state pays 50,000 baht per meter for 5–10 kW systems, limited to 1 million places. The money is paid only after the utility confirms the grid connection.



Installation follows survey and approval; no installation start date announced yet

Item	Condition
Reference kit price	140,000 baht (5 kW system)
Loans	BAAC / GH Bank at 2.5% a year over 7 years · GSB details not yet announced
Sell-back	2.20 baht per unit
Installers	Must be registered with PEA or MEA
Restrictions	Cannot be combined with the 200,000-baht tax deduction · state welfare card holders give up 20 years of free-electricity benefit

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Impact on small installers

The Vendor Handbook (27 October 2026) protects consumers well, but it needs a lot of working capital that ordinary labour-based installers may not have.

50,000–60,000 baht
bank guarantee per job, 6 months

10,000 baht
security per job, 7 years

7 years
workmanship warranty + fire insurance

Every year
panel cleaning and maintenance

24 hours
response to faults

Engineer
licensed design engineer required

Guarantees needed when taking several jobs at once



Based on the maximum 60,000-baht security per job, excluding equipment.

The installer page SolarHub summed up the handbook as “That’s it – whoever wants it, take it”. WAY Solar announced it will not join, citing long-term business risk.

Possible result: well-funded companies win most jobs and pass them down to small installers as subcontractors. Independent installers may slowly disappear.

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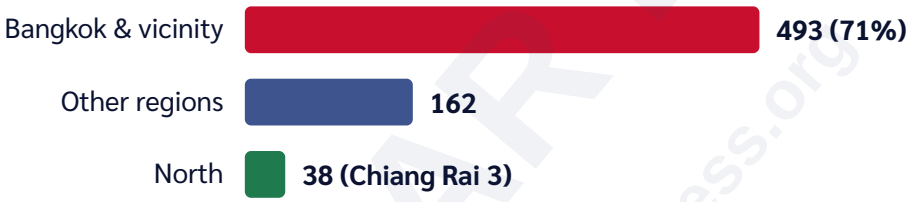
Who is on the approved installer list

PEA's list of 693 approved installers includes firms of many sizes, but they are concentrated in and around Bangkok, and utility subsidiaries compete too (data as of 28 October 2026).

Type of business



Office location



Utility subsidiaries Two PEA ENCOM subsidiaries are on the list, and MEA has a subsidiary that installs home solar (MEAei), alongside large groups such as SCG, Banpu NEXT, BCPG, B.Grimm, Gulf, EA, HomePro and Dohome. How jobs are spread across installers should be made public.

PEA and MEA must be rule protectors only, not players in the free market
Those who write the rules, approve installers and connect systems should not compete for the work themselves. A market is fair and trusted only when the referee does not play.

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What it means for households: which option?

50,000-baht subsidy

- Limited to 1 million places
- Approved installers only
- Loan of about 90,000 baht, about 1,200 baht a month for 7 years
- Installed after survey (to June 2027)
- Suits middle and lower incomes

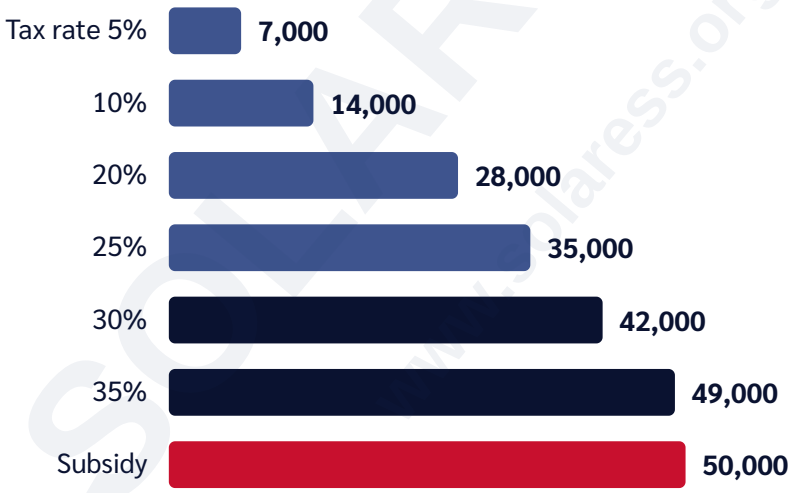
Tax deduction up to 200,000 baht

- Until 31 Dec 2028, no cap on numbers
- Choose your own installer, brand and size
- Install right away
- Needs a full e-Tax Invoice
- Worthwhile at a 25% tax rate or higher

Net metering

- Not yet available in Thailand
- Unit-for-unit offset
- No handout, no debt
- Suits homes that use power in the evening

Tax saving compared with the subsidy (140,000-baht system)

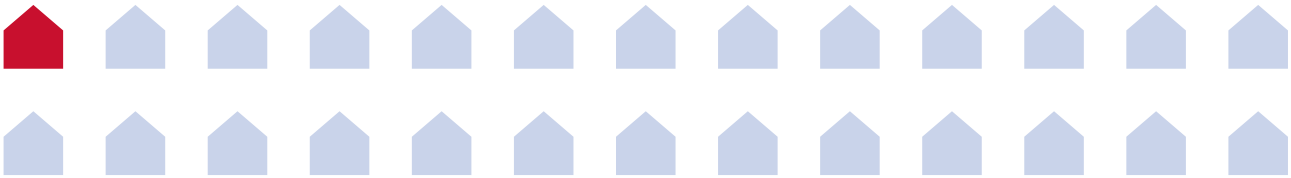


Tax saved = top marginal rate × installation cost (up to 200,000 baht, e.g. 35% × 200,000 = 70,000 baht). Ask an accountant about your own case.

Before you decide Note your meter reading between 8:00 and 16:00 for a week to see whether your daytime use is high enough for bill savings plus sell-back income to cover the loan instalments.

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Limited places



1 in 26 households can get the subsidy (1 million out of about 26 million). Most renters, condo residents and families without a suitable roof are left out. Experts estimate actual installation capacity at about 300,000 homes before the September 2027 connection deadline.

Net metering risks being overshadowed

Today (net billing)	Net metering
Daytime: sell surplus **2.20 baht/unit**	Daytime surplus **Offset 1 : 1** against night-time use at the same price
Night: buy power **≈3.9–4 baht/unit**	

The state is concerned about grid costs and the effect on customers without solar

With public attention on the 50,000-baht subsidy, the push for net metering may weaken, although in the long run it is likely fairer and reaches more people. It deserves serious study and public consultation alongside the subsidy.

Net metering answers this directly. Every unit people produce is worth the same as a unit they buy, so every home has a reason to produce as much as it can. That is what the country needs as demand rises fast.

Net metering is the tool that confirms fairness and neutrality in how we use energy
One unit people produce is worth one unit they use. No side gains or loses. This is our ultimate goal.

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Recommendations

The idea behind all our proposals

Rising energy demand asks everyone to produce as much as they can. People must be able to take part freely and fairly, and get a fair benefit. Electricity is a public utility for everyone's survival and sustainability, not a profit tool for one group.

Three main proposals

1 Put every option on the table and let people choose freely

Set out the approach, how it would work and the expected result of each option (the 50,000-baht subsidy, the 200,000-baht tax deduction, net metering and others) clearly and completely, then let people decide.

2 PEA and MEA must be rule protectors only, not players in the free market

The utilities are best placed to set standards, inspect and connect systems. When the rule-maker or its subsidiaries also compete for installation work, their neutrality is questioned, and this may not fit the intent of Section 75 of the 2017 Constitution, which says the state shall not run businesses that compete with the private sector except where the law provides.

3 Net metering is the ultimate goal

It is the tool that confirms fairness and neutrality in producing and using energy: one unit produced is worth one unit used, and everyone can produce freely. It is the most important way to meet fast-rising demand from homes, businesses and new industries such as data centres.

Further recommendations

4 Security sized to the business
Adjust guarantees so small installers can take part

5 Publish how jobs are shared
Jobs per installer, including utility subsidiaries

6 Look after those left out
Measures for renters, condo residents and low-income families

7 For homeowners
Check daytime use, compare every option and always get warranties in writing

Where Solar ESS stands

Standards and safety matter, and we believe a diversity of installers and fair access matter just as much. Solar ESS proposes the personal income tax deduction of up to 200,000 baht as the more practical approach for our future electricity use, and net metering as the best and most practical approach. We install systems with a full e-Tax Invoice for the tax deduction and are happy to compare every option honestly.

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Conclusion

Clean energy is truly sustainable only when it is clean at the source and in how its benefits are shared. If the system is designed so that only “the fittest” survive, small installers working to the same standards will slowly become subcontractors to a few large groups. The benefits will stay with a few while most people lose their role.

RE100 today judges electricity at its source, and our research confirms it has no community requirement. But clean-power buyers, investors and ESG frameworks increasingly look at the social side. Power produced in a way that reduces diversity and shuts out small players may not stay accepted in the long run.

Now that the world and Thailand need more energy than ever, everyone must be honest and produce to their full potential. People should take part freely and fairly, and get a fair benefit from the power they produce. Electricity is not a tool for profit. It is a public utility that helps us all survive and sustain together.

We hope the next stage of policy will make room for households, local installers and small businesses to grow alongside large investment, so that Thailand’s clean power is power everyone shares in and benefits from.

Sources

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Based on public sources as of 28 October 2026. The Vendor Handbook may still be a draft. This report is not tax or financial advice.